Riccardo Pala

Software & AI Engineer

Software & AI Engineer with 3+ years of experience developing Java/Spring Boot systems and LLM-powered RAG platforms for two major Italian banking groups. Focused on backend services, financial data enrichment and semantic retrieval. M.Sc. in Computer Science & Engineering, AI specialization.

Milan, Italy
Open to Barcelona

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PROFESSIONAL EXPERIENCE

Silicon Shoring FS Reply

Senior Consultant · Milan, Italy · Jun 2023 — Present

Web & Mobile Banking Platforms · Major Italian banking group

- Develop Java/Spring Boot REST APIs and microservices supporting production web and mobile banking platforms, including data services and integrations across distributed systems.
- Build event-driven integrations with Apache Kafka and Oracle-backed services; contribute to production reliability and maintainable service design.
- Translate business and change requirements into technical solutions, contribute to architecture decisions, and prepare effort and cost estimates.
- Coordinate planning, task definition and delivery progress; monitor timelines and financial performance for assigned projects.

Conversational PFM & Agentic RAG Platform · Major Italian banking group

Feb 2026 — Present

- Develop Java/Spring Boot components for transaction merchant normalization, categorization and geolocation, designed for concurrent processing and low latency.
- Implement hybrid structured and embedding-based retrieval with PostgreSQL/pgvector, similarity ranking and relevance thresholds to retrieve transaction context.
- Contribute to a Python Agentic RAG system that supplies financial context for LLM-generated responses and supports conversational personal finance workflows.
- Act as a technical reference for the team and stakeholders: guide implementation decisions, coordinate engineering work and lead project status reviews.

SELECTED PUBLICATION

ACM RecSys Challenge 2022 · Co-author

Lightweight Model for Session-Based Recommender Systems with Seasonality Information in the Fashion Domain.

EDUCATION

M.Sc. Computer Science & Engineering (AI)

Politecnico di Milano · 2020–2023

110/110 cum laude

Machine Learning, Deep Learning, Recommender Systems, Game Theory.

Research Exchange · Explainable AI

Universidad Politécnica de Madrid · 2022–2023

Thesis: Robustness of Ensemble Explanations (AXOM). **10/10, top 5%.**

CERTIFICATION

Confluent Certified Developer for Apache Kafka

CCDAK · Feb 2026

TECHNICAL SKILLS

Backend

Java, Spring Boot, REST APIs, microservices, Apache Kafka, Oracle

Applied AI

Python, Agentic RAG, LLM workflows, embeddings, semantic retrieval

Data

PostgreSQL, pgvector, transaction enrichment, similarity ranking

LANGUAGES

Italian · Native

English · C1 (TOEIC 955)

Spanish · Conversational